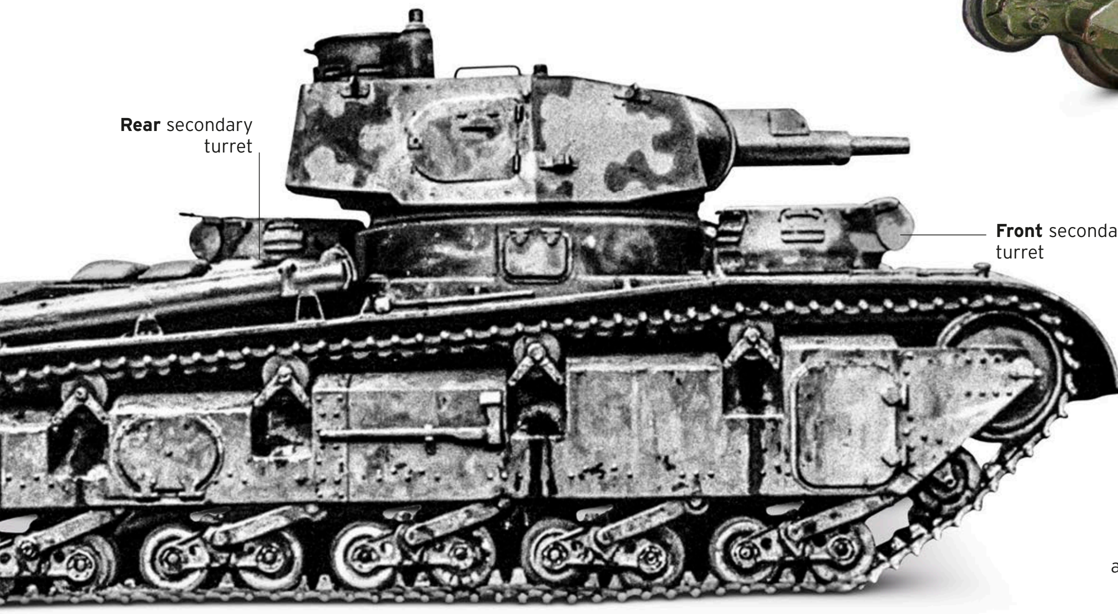
▷ Christie M1931

Date 1931 **Country** USA
Weight 11.8 tons (10.7 tonnes)
Engine Liberty V12 gasoline, 338 hp
Main armament .50 Browning M2 machine gun

Designed by J. Walter Christie, the M1931 was a follow-up to the turretless M1928. Unlike its predecessor, it was purchased by the US Army, but more influential were the two bought by the Soviets: these evolved into the BT series and the T-34. The tank's suspension and light armor allowed for very high speed, even on rough ground.



▽ Amphibious Light Tank

Date 1939 **Country** UK
Weight 4.8 tons (4.4 tonnes)
Engine Meadows 6-cylinder EST gasoline, 89 hp
Main armament .303 Vickers machine gun

This vehicle was designed for British requirements and was based mechanically on the Vickers Light Tank, rather than the company's earlier amphibious vehicle. Its hull was surrounded by kapok-filled aluminium floats, and it was driven in water by two propellers.

△ Panzerkampfwagen Neubaufahrzeug

Date 1934 **Country** Germany
Weight 40.3 tons (36.6 tonnes)
Engine BMV Va gasoline, 290 hp
Main armament 7.5 cm KwK 37 L/24 gun and 3.7 cm KwK 36 L/45 gun

Intended as the standard German heavy tank to complement the Panzer I–IV vehicles, just five Neubaufahrzeugs were built, including two prototypes. The two main guns were mounted in the same turret, with two smaller machine-gun turrets firing forward and backward. The three combat vehicles saw limited service in Norway in 1940.

▽ Stridsvagn fm/31

Date 1935 **Country** Sweden
Weight 12.9 tons (11.7 tonnes)
Engine Maybach DSO 8 gasoline, 150 hp
Main armament 37 mm Bofors m/38 gun

One weakness of early tanks was their tracks, which wore out quickly. To overcome this, many countries experimented with tanks that could carry their own wheels. This unique Swedish vehicle could raise or lower its wheels in 30 seconds. However, as tracks became more reliable during the 1930s, convertible vehicles were rendered unneccessary.